

Classifieds platforms are built for the seller and the transaction. The buyer gets a keyword box. That is the gap vindje is built in.

18.7M

live Marktplaats listings, 350,000 added daily [1] [5]

73%

of online reuse, self-reported by Marktplaats [5]

7%

of Dutch people 15+ hit by purchase fraud in 2024 [16]

0

platforms here that show buyers what items sold for

50–60%

of UK C2C apparel taken by Vinted in four years [25]

€6.95

to €10.95 a month, already charged for listing alerts [21]

Observations from the industry. From public sources. Company-reported and review-site figures are labelled, because neither is a representative sample.

Search matches keywords, not descriptions

It needs the Dutch noun a seller typed. Attributes are optional, so size and included parts cannot be filtered. Marktplaats publishes anti-stuffing rules. [15]

Sold prices are not published anywhere

Unlike eBay, no Dutch platform shows what comparable items went for, and auction ads put an opening bid in the price position.

Platform investment goes to sellers

eBay now builds a listing from photographs alone. Buyer-side tooling across the industry is a keyword box and paid placement. [29]

Complaints concentrate on trust, not relevance

Fraud surviving reports, protection charged either way, no route to a human, bans after registration. Self-selected sample. [9][10] [11]

Fraud is the buyer's main exposure

CBS: purchase fraud hit 7% of people 15+ in 2024, up from 5.6% in 2022, ahead of every other online fraud type. [16]

Category share can move in four years

Reporting on CMA analysis puts Vinted at 50 to 60% of UK C2C apparel in 2025, from 5 to 10% in 2021, on free listing and one category. [25]

Fee incidence has shifted to the buyer

Marktplaats charges the buyer for protection, Vinted charges sellers nothing, and eBay dropped UK private seller fees in 2024. [13][27][28]

Solved trust was solved operationally

Avito holds funds and moves goods. Zhuanzhuan closed unmediated C2C in 2025, citing disputes and margins, and kept inspection. [36][47]

The engagement leaders are not search products

Xianyu reports 209M monthly actives across 1.3M interest groups. Whatnot reports doubling volume on live auctions. [39] [33]

A paid buyer-side layer already exists

Three Dutch services sell faster listing alerts at €6.95 to €10.95 a month, and one advertises model-based filtering. [21][22][23]

The direction, and what vindje should stand for. A layer on supply that already exists, on the buyer's side of it. Three commitments, each with what it rules out.

One

Paid by the buyer, so it can answer to the buyer

Platform revenue comes from sellers, listings and the transaction, so no incumbent is paid to tell a buyer that nothing here fits.

Rules out seller tools, paid placement, and any fee that grows with transaction volume.

Two

Shows its work, every time

Each match states why it matched, each rejection is counted and grouped, and each price verdict shows how many comparable items it rests on.

Rules out silent ranking, undisclosed placement, and a number without the data behind it.

Three

Says nothing when it does not know

Fraud is the buyer's main worry in this market, so a confident wrong price or a jumpy risk flag costs more than an empty state.

Rules out filling a thin comparable set, or a missing attribute, with a plausible guess.

Ten hypotheses to test. Each states its test and the result that kills it. Thresholds are judgement calls, sized to be decidable in weeks at current traffic.

Hypothesis	How it is tested	Falsified if
H1 Match quality is already good enough to build on	50 hand-labelled wishes across five categories, run against one frozen listing snapshot, reporting precision, recall and cost per search	Precision below 70%
H2 Constraint-rich wishes are where the value sits	Parse and store the constraint count per search, then compare listing views per search across constraint bands over four weeks of live traffic	No positive relationship
H3 The stated reason is what makes a result usable	Equal-split A/B, reason line shown against hidden, decided at a sample fixed before the test starts	No positive difference
H4 Disclosing what was hidden builds trust rather than doubt	A/B on the "43 listings hidden, here is why" panel, measured on 7 day return rate, not on clicks	The disclosure arm returns less
H5 A saved search turns a one-time visit into a habit	Offer a saved search at the end of results. Measure creation rate, then 7 day return for creators against one-time searchers	Creation under 10%
H6 Buyers will pay for a saved search	Free tier of two searches at 15 minute checks, paid tier at the price the market already charges. Measure conversion among users with an active search over three weeks	Conversion under 2%
H7 A price verdict changes what buyers do	A/B verdict against no verdict on seller-contact clicks, plus one in-product question to users who saw it. Direction is uncertain: a calibrated verdict should also prevent some purchases	Neither contacts nor stated decisions move
H8 Risk flags can be made accurate enough to publish	Run rules plus model inspection over listings users reported as suspicious and over a hand-labelled clean set. Report recall and false positives separately	False positives above 20%
H9 Buyers who do not write Dutch are a distinct segment	Split engagement and 30 day retention by input language, and interview five non-Dutch speakers to read the quantitative result	The two groups behave alike
H10 Dutch long-tail pages acquire buyers at a workable cost	Publish 200 constraint pages and 25 valuation pages, measure organic sessions and saved-search conversion at day 90, with a €500 category-intent ads test as the comparison	Under 1,000 sessions a month, or over €3 per saved search

50

labelled wishes, the fixed set every quality claim is measured against

1

frozen listing snapshot, so results stay comparable between runs

5

user interviews a week, recorded, to read the numbers against

0

features shipped without events, since an untracked test decides nothing

2

weeks maximum per A/B, with the sample fixed in advance

4

weeks to first read on H1 to H6, the ones that gate the rest

Sources, live links. Requested 15 Sep 2026: 40 of 47 returned HTTP 200, six answer a bot challenge and open in a browser, one host was unreachable. All 47 with access notes in the long version.

[1] Wikipedia, Marktplaats.nl
[10] Radar forum, avrotros.nl
[15] Keyword rules, Marktplaats help
[22] MPAlerts, returned 403
[27] Vinted 2025 results, company
[33] Whatnot volume, ebrun.com
[47] Zhuanzhuan closes C2C, Yicai

[5] Marktplaats Effect, company
[11] App reviews, play.google.com
[16] CBS online fraud 2024
[23] Marktplaats Scanner
[28] eBay drops UK seller fees
[36] Avito delivery, ship24.com

[9] Trustpilot, self-selected
[13] Buyer protection costs, secondary
[21] MarktAlert, a competitor
[25] CMA via Value Added Resource
[29] eBay listing from photos
[39] Xianyu, chinatalk.nl